Quartzline Yard OS

CUSTOMER CASE STUDY

# Pallet & Porter Cuts Trailer Detention 58% Across 23 Distribution Yards

**Industry:** Regional grocery distribution · **Fleet:** 410 tractors, 1,900 trailers · **Deployment:** 23 yards in 11 months · **Go-live:** March 2025

## THE CHALLENGE

Pallet & Porter's yards ran on whiteboards and radio calls. Gate clerks logged arrivals on paper; spotters learned of moves by driving the lot. During the 2024 holiday peak, average trailer detention reached 4.6 hours, and the carrier surcharges that followed erased most of the quarter's transportation savings.

Worse, nobody could answer the simple question "where is trailer 8841?" without a physical yard walk. Perishable loads were twice discovered after their reefer fuel ran out — a six-figure loss each time and a compliance report to a major retail partner.

## THE SOLUTION

Quartzline deployed its Yard OS with solar RTLS tags on every trailer and a gate kiosk that cut check-in to under a minute. Spotter moves are now dispatched by the optimizer, which sequences work against dock schedules and reefer fuel telemetry rather than radio seniority.

Rollout ran region by region — three pilot yards in six weeks, then a template-driven expansion handled by two Quartzline engineers and Pallet & Porter's own ops trainers. No yard closed for cutover; the longest gate downtime recorded was eleven minutes.

*“We used to staff an extra spotter per shift just to find trailers. Now the system knows where everything is before the driver has parked — my gate team found two hours a day they didn't know they had.”*

REINA CALLOWAY · VP OF DISTRIBUTION OPERATIONS, PALLET & PORTER FOODS

# Results After Two Full Peak Seasons

**58%**
Reduction in average trailer detention, from 4.6 hours to 1.9 hours per load

**$3.4M**
Annualized savings in carrier detention surcharges and spotter overtime

**99.2%**
Trailer location accuracy at audit, up from an estimated 71% on paper logs

**0**
Reefer fuel-out events since go-live, down from 11 in the prior year

**47 sec**
Median gate check-in time, down from 6 minutes with paper processing

**14 mo**
Payback period on the full 23-yard deployment, measured by finance

## DEPLOYMENT TIMELINE

**MAR 2025**
Pilot live at three Carolina yards; RTLS tagging of 240 trailers

**MAY 2025**
Pilot review: detention down 41%; board approves full rollout

**AUG 2025**
Midwest region complete; optimizer takes over spotter dispatch

**NOV 2025**
All 23 yards live ahead of holiday peak; reefer telemetry wired in

**FEB 2026**
Finance certifies 14-month payback; phase two (carrier portal) begins

**See what your yards are hiding.**

Quartzline deploys a single-yard pilot in six weeks, with success metrics you define before we start. quartzline.example/pilot

BOOK A YARD AUDIT